

3.4 Opera



The Opera Browser

Opera has always been seen as a browser for users who do not trust IE and want something faster and lighter than Netscape. The Opera browser was started in 1994 as a research project in Norway's telecom company Telenor. Two engineers from the same company developed the browser Opera for the company's intranet. On July 14th 1996, Opera's co-founder Jon von Tetzchner made the first public announcement of Opera on UseNet and Opera came into being for the general public.

Opera was written from a scratch and is not based on the NCSA Mosaic code or interface methodology (as Internet Explorer or Netscape are.) This gives it some unique browsing features such as page zoom, a multi-document interface browsing environment and mouse gestures. It has an extremely small footprint and boasts of an impressive feature set, with great sup-